however, despite India pointing to the Chinese threat as its reason for testing nuclear weapons, China's reaction was moderate. Since then, India–China relations have been on a generally positive trajectory. Then, when the India–US Agreement on Civil Nuclear Cooperation was going forward in 2005, India and China reached agreement on the "Political Parameters and Guiding Principles for the Settlement of the India-China Boundary Question" - perhaps the most significant success of 17 rounds of talks of the special representatives negotiating the India–China boundary. India's actions to buttress its own security and build closer strategic ties with the United States acted as incentives for China to engage on more cooperative measures with India. The Agreement came at a time when India also had excellent relations with Russia, the European Union, and key European countries and when India's relations with Japan were beginning to warm up. Military strength and positive equations with other countries have encouraged realistic responses that avoid conflict and encourage the pursuit of policies that are cooperative.

The rest of this chapter consists of four parts. The first part defines the geographic perimeter of the new Indo-Pacific region and India's view of it. The second part outlines the broad consonance of geopolitical imperatives that India and the United States have in this region. The next part discusses India's approach to China in the Indo-Pacific, while in the fourth and final part of the chapter, the author discusses how both balance-of-power politics and increased interdependence are required as two parallel tools for stability in the region.

Defining the Indo-Pacific